patients. Milk is restricted as it is a high residue diet. Fermented, cooked and diluted milk products are tolerated well than whole milk by the patients.

Fat

Fat is restricted as it may aggravate diarrhoea. Invisible fat (fat in an invisible form or already present in the food) like egg yolk, whole milk, paneer, curd, meat, sea foods etc is preferred more as compared to visible fat like oils and dalda. Fried food must be avoided.

Carbohydrate

Adequate carbohydrate should be given (60-65% of total calories). Easily assimilated carbohydrates are preferred. Potato, yam, sago, semolina, refined flour, honey, jaggery can be given for patients with diarrhoea to reduce the volume of stools.

Fibre

Low fibre diet is prescribed for the patient. Insoluble fibre in the form of skins, seeds and bran should be avoided to minimize irritation of gastro intestinal tract. Soluble fibre foods like stewed fruits and vegetables help in binding the stool and favour beneficial gut health.

Vitamins and Minerals

The water soluble vitamins especially folic acid, vitamin B_{12} and vitamin C should be supplemented. Fat soluble vitamins (A, D, E and K) are supplemented if fat is not digested and lost in stools. Sodium and potassium should be replaced.

Fluids

Intake of fluids should be liberal to minimize risk of dehydration. Diluted drinks are preferred than concentrated drinks.

Activity : 1

Circle the food which can be given for diarrhoea from the following.

1. Curd 2. Fried foods 3. Milk
4. Biriyani 5. Egg yolk

Stages of diet therapy in Chronic Diarrhoea

Level I diet
Low milk diet, curd, rice and milk
Level II diet
Milk free diet, amylase rich food
Level III diet
Lactose free, Sucrose free, starch free diet, Soy, chicken and egg

HOME REMEDIES
For Diarrhoea

- Thyme can settle churning stomach and kill bacteria. Add a teaspoon of thyme in one cup of boiling water, steep, strain and drink.
- A plate of carrots can soothe the digestive system
- Mix cumin seed powder with curd and take it three times a day

Foods to be included and avoided for Diarrhoea

Foods to be included	Foods to be avoided
Buttermilk	Whole milk
Thin dal and soft cooked dal	Legumes, nuts
Boiled Egg	Fried foods
Vegetable soups	Raw vegetables
Vegetable juices or cooked pureed vegetables	Pickles
Fruit juices	Coarse cereals
Banana, Apple, Papaya and Melons	Whole grain breads
Coconut Water	
Kheer, homemade jelly and custard	
Soft cooked rice and refined cereals	

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